Business SME Walkthrough – Evidence Package

Contents

Meeting Details

Date: 10th August 2026

Audience:

Calvin (Business SME), Divy and Priya (Technical SME's), Dan (Senior Finance Manager and Project Sponsor)

Purpose

The purpose of this session was to provide business stakeholders with an overview of the scenario modelling framework, why it was developed, and how it is intended to improve the current portfolio scenario process. The discussion focused on the business problem being addressed, including the reliance on multiple manual files, specialist SME interpretation, limited transparency, and the need for a more reproducible way to configure, compare, and explain scenarios.

The walkthrough also demonstrated how the framework supports business users through standardised inputs, financial entity-to-case translation, configurable scenario operations, validation checks, and scenario output analysis. Stakeholder questions were used to test whether the approach addressed key business concerns around auditability, data refresh, version control, manual input governance, and potential future modelling needs such as farm-down or divestment scenarios.

Meeting Notes

Part 1: Background and Business Need for Scenario Modelling Framework [02:11]

I provided context for the meeting by outlining the business need for a scenario modelling framework, referencing the original request from Al and the requirements from Ali's and Pam's teams, with Calvin, Dan, and Divyratn participating in the discussion.

- **Origin of the Request:** I explained that the idea for a formal scenario modelling framework originated from a request by Al, the SVP, in October, aiming to support Ali's upstream portfolio team in building and comparing portfolio scenarios efficiently.
- **Key Requirements:** The framework was designed to allow users to switch investments or cases on and off, adjust timing, model A&D activity, and compare impacts on production and financial metrics both pre- and post-tax, as well as to support transparent and reproducible scenario analysis.
- **Stakeholder Involvement:** I highlighted that the main stakeholders were Ali's team and Pam's team, with Calvin and Tingting providing input, and that the framework was intended to address their workflow pain points and requirements.

Part 2: Current State Analysis and Identified Challenges [06:58]

I described the current manual, fragmented process for scenario modelling, emphasizing the reliance on SME knowledge, risks of errors, and inefficiencies, with Dan and Calvin contributing questions and comments.

- **Manual Workflow Description:** I detailed the current process, which involves extracting data from SAP, managing around 80 Excel files, and manually linking data into the plan book, resulting in a time-intensive and error-prone workflow.
- **Risks and Challenges:** Key risks identified include the need for specialist SME knowledge, fragmented tools and data structures, limited traceability, and recurring reconciliation and rework, making the process difficult for new team members and increasing the potential for errors.
- **SME Knowledge Dependency:** Dan questioned whether the new framework aimed to reduce the need for SME interpretation, and I clarified that while SME knowledge would always be

necessary, the goal was to increase transparency and reproducibility, making it easier for others to understand and audit the process.

Part 3: Design and Architecture of the New Scenario Modelling Framework [11:04]

I presented the architecture of the new scenario modelling framework, explaining its single-source data approach, integration of manual feeds, and use of a semantic model, with Calvin raising questions about data refresh and technical integration.

- **Single-Source Data Model:** I described how the framework pulls data once from a single source, typically the Azure Data Lake, and integrates it into a Power BI semantic model, reducing redundancy and improving data governance.
- **Integration of Manual Feeds:** The framework supports standardized manual input templates for cases where data is not available in SAP, ensuring these inputs are structured and validated before integration into the model.
- **Translation Template:** A translation template is used to map financial entities to modelling cases, allowing for aggregation at various levels (region, country, area, etc.) and supporting overrides for custom groupings, mirroring the plan book structure.
- **Data Refresh and Technical Considerations:** Calvin asked about data refresh mechanisms, and I explained that while the current process is designed for periodic refreshes, direct SAP connections could be considered for more frequent updates, depending on business needs.

Part 4: Demonstration of the Scenario Modelling Tool [17:42]

I conducted a live demonstration of the scenario modelling tool, showcasing the translation template, standardized input schedules, scenario configuration, and the model engine, with Dan and Calvin asking clarifying questions.

- **Financial Entity to Case Translation:** I demonstrated how the translation template aggregates financial entities into modelling cases, supports overrides, and provides visibility into aggregation methods and the resulting case structure.
- **Standardized Manual Input Templates:** I showed the standardized input templates, which enforce valid metadata entry and provide validation checks to ensure data integrity before integration into the model.

- **Scenario Configuration and Operations:** The tool allows users to configure up to five scenarios, select cases to include or exclude, and apply various operations (e.g., delay, accelerate, farm down, scale) with parameterized inputs, supporting a wide range of scenario modelling needs.
- **Model Engine and Error Handling:** I explained the workflow for refreshing data, running the scenario engine, and updating outputs, highlighting the model engine log for auditability and error messages that guide users to resolve configuration issues.
- **Output Visualization and Analysis:** The tool generates outputs in pivot tables and charts, allowing users to analyze scenario results, including financial impacts of operations like delays and farm downs, with plans to integrate with Power BI for advanced variance analysis.

Part 5: Feedback, Next Steps, and Degree Module Support [52:32]

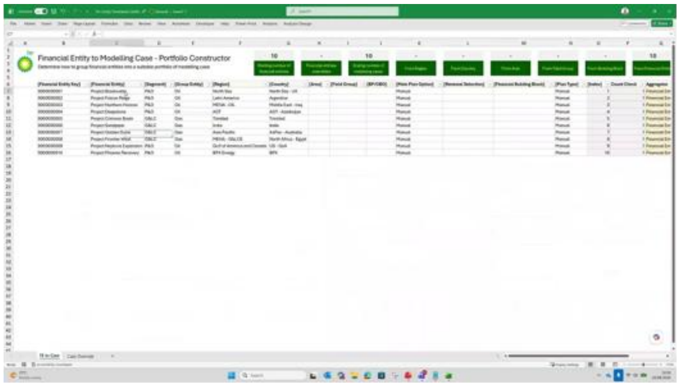
I requested written feedback from the team via a Microsoft Forms survey to support both business improvement and my degree module, with Dan, Calvin, and Divyratn agreeing to provide input and participate in further technical discussions.

Feedback Request: I asked participants to provide feedback on the tool's usability, efficiency gains, and transparency, both for business improvement and as evidence for my degree module.

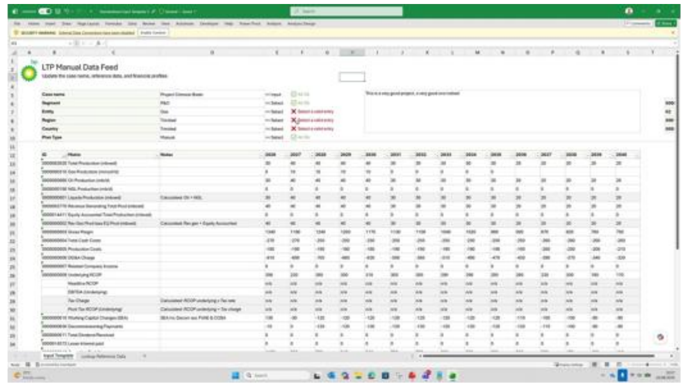
Survey Distribution: I distributed a Microsoft Forms survey via email and encouraged the team to complete it after testing the tool.

Next Steps and Technical Deep Dive: I mentioned a planned technical deep dive session for those interested in the backend implementation, inviting Calvin and others to join for further discussion on technical aspects and potential plan book optimization.

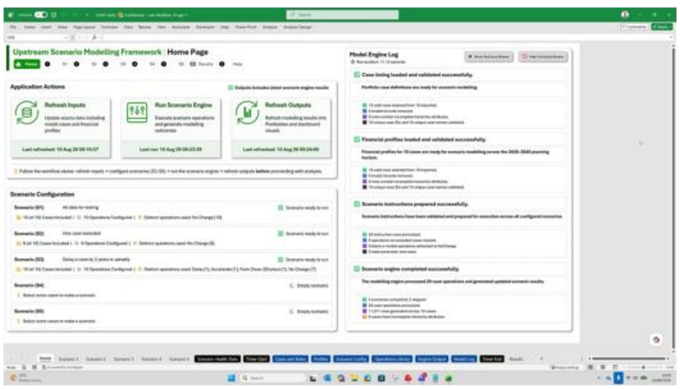
Live Demonstration Screenshot Evidence



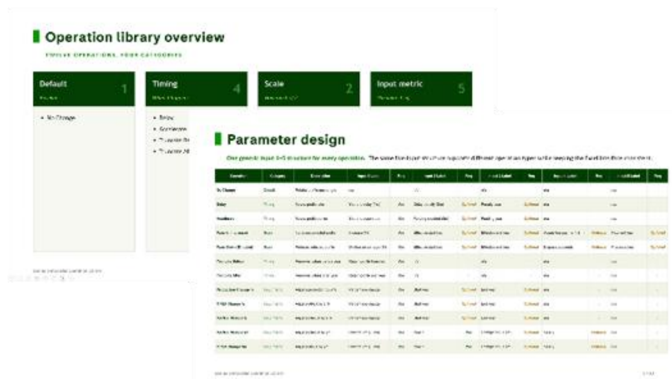
Financial entity to modelling case constructor



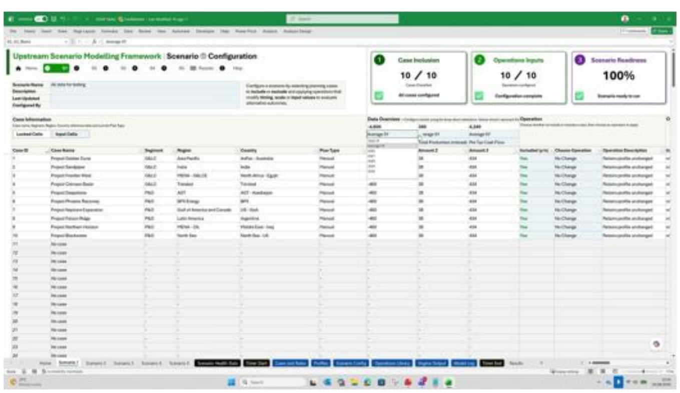
Controlled manual data input schedule



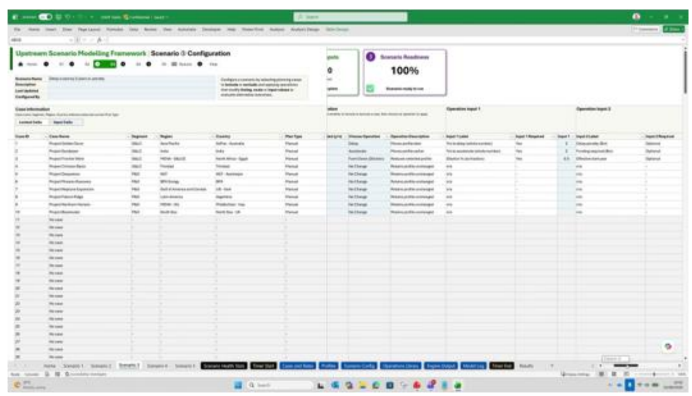
Excel application home page



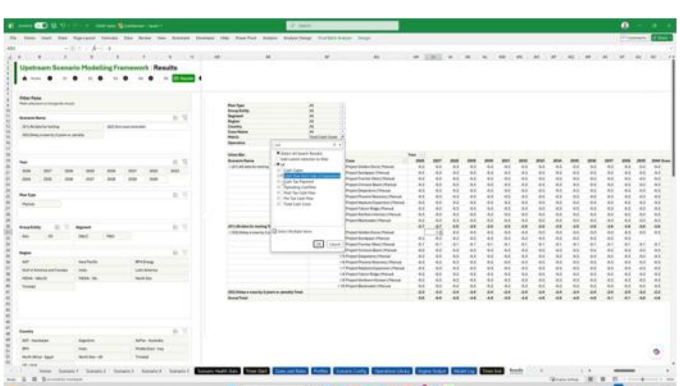
Model operations available and how to input



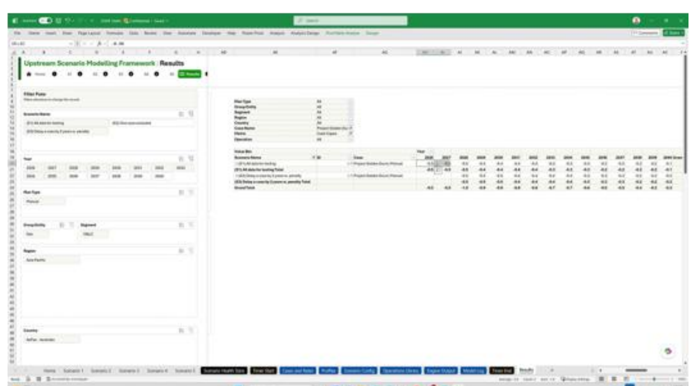
User workflow – inclusion decision



User workflow – operation decision



Reviewing the results



Verifying the delay of 2 years

Key Questions Raised

1. Transparency and SME dependency

Question raised: Is the objective to reduce dependency on specialist interpretation by making the scenario process more transparent and easier to follow?

Answer: I explained that SME knowledge would still be required, but the framework makes assumptions, transformations, and scenario decisions more visible, repeatable, and auditable.

Reflection: This confirmed that the value of the framework is not removing expertise, but reducing reliance on undocumented knowledge and making the process easier for others to review or continue.

2. Data refresh and source changes

Question raised: If the underlying source data changes, would the scenario model still need to be refreshed?

Answer: I confirmed that refreshes would still be needed when source data changes, but the framework reduces repeated extraction by collecting data once into a governed dataset rather than across many separate files.

Reflection: This highlighted a practical limitation: the model improves control and repeatability, but does not remove the need for an agreed refresh cycle and clear ownership of source data updates.

3. Governance of manual inputs

Question raised: How are manual profiles checked before being accepted into the scenario model?

Answer: I explained that standardised input templates use validation logic, controlled selections, and checks across segment, region, country, and entity combinations before data is integrated.

Reflection: This was important evidence that the framework treats manual data as a governed input, rather than an informal adjustment outside the model process.

4. Financial entity aggregation

Question raised: How are detailed financial entities grouped into a smaller number of modelling cases?

Answer: I described how entities can be aggregated by region, country, area, field group, or individual entity, with overrides available where a customised business grouping is required.

Reflection: This showed that the framework can simplify the modelling structure while still preserving traceability over how each case has been constructed.

5. Version control and scenario history

Question raised: If new data is refreshed into the model, how can previous scenario outputs be retained, revisited, or compared?

Answer: I noted that the current Excel implementation supports active scenario comparison, but a more formal export or repository mechanism would be needed to preserve historical model runs.

Reflection: This identified a clear future enhancement area, particularly if the model is used repeatedly across planning cycles or becomes part of a wider Power BI reporting workflow.

6. Supported scenario operations

Question raised: What types of changes can users apply when configuring scenarios?

Answer: I explained that users can include or exclude cases, delay or accelerate profiles, truncate time periods, scale values, and apply production, OpEx, CapEx, or dilution-style adjustments using configurable parameters.

Reflection: This demonstrated that the model supports more than static comparison, enabling controlled testing of multiple business assumptions through a consistent scenario configuration process.

7. Farm-down and ownership change scenarios

Question raised: Could the framework model ownership changes, such as a farm-down, divestment, or conversion to a different asset treatment?

Answer: I explained that the current model does not fully cover accounting treatment changes for ownership movements, but the logic could be added once the detailed business rules are defined.

Reflection: This was a useful challenge because it tested whether the framework could support more complex future use cases, rather than only the initial scenario operations demonstrated in the session.

8. Error handling and user guidance

Question raised: What happens if a user enters an invalid scenario instruction or configuration?

Answer: I showed that the engine validates scenario instructions during execution and stops processing when a configuration error is detected, returning a message that identifies the affected scenario, record, and reason for failure.

Reflection: This helped evidence that the tool includes practical controls for business users, reducing the risk of silent errors being carried through into scenario outputs.

Closing Feedback and Overall Themes

Immediate feedback from the session was positive. Stakeholders described the framework as making sense, being very good, and representing a strong application of the scenario modelling approach. One participant also described it as a wonderful application and a great product.

Notable feedback: “That makes sense”; “Very good”; “wonderful application”; “great product”. Stakeholders were also interested to see how the framework performs under real-world use and supported the distribution of the feedback survey.

The strongest discussion themes were transparency and auditability, version control and scenario history, data refresh limitations, and future modelling capability for farm-down, divestment, or IJV-style scenarios.

Overall, the session provided useful business validation evidence. It confirmed that the framework was understood by stakeholders, generated constructive challenge, and highlighted where further development could strengthen its use beyond the initial demonstration.

Appendix: Business SME Email

Upstream scenario modelling awareness session and demo - Message (HTML)

File Message Help Tell me what you want to do

Upstream scenario modelling awareness session and demo

Deaton, Daniel

Redacted

Reply Reply All Forward

Mon 10/08/2026 07:59

Confidential\Internal

Encrypted - Permission granted by: daniel.deaton@uk.bp.com

USMF - Operations.pdf 3 MB

USMF - SME Engagement.pdf 1 MB

Hi everyone,

During the meeting today, I would like to take you through the scenario modelling framework I have been developing and seek your feedback on its design, functionality, and business logic.

I would like to record the session and as such will be using dummy data only.

I have attached a short context deck covering:

- the origin and purpose of the request;
- the current-state data flows and workflows used by the planning team to support LTP scenario modelling; and
- an overview of the proposed scenario modelling framework.

The framework currently includes:

- **Single-source data provision:** SAP to Azure, Power BI, and Excel.
- **Controlled mapping schedules:** supporting financial entity grouping, renaming, and translation.
- **Standardised manual input schedules:** allowing non-SAP financial profiles to be incorporated consistently.
- **Scenario configuration screens:** enabling case-by-case operations, including:
  - delay, with an optional penalty;
  - acceleration, with an optional funding requirement;
  - farm-in, including funding;
  - farm-down, including proceeds;
  - truncation before or after a selected year; and
  - production, CAPEX, and OPEX adjustments by percentage or absolute amount.
- **Automated financialisation:** now including tax calculations.
- **A lightweight Power Pivot-driven Excel dashboard.**
- **A transparent application control page:** allowing users to:
  - retrieve the latest source data;
  - run the scenario engine; and
  - refresh the output visualisations.

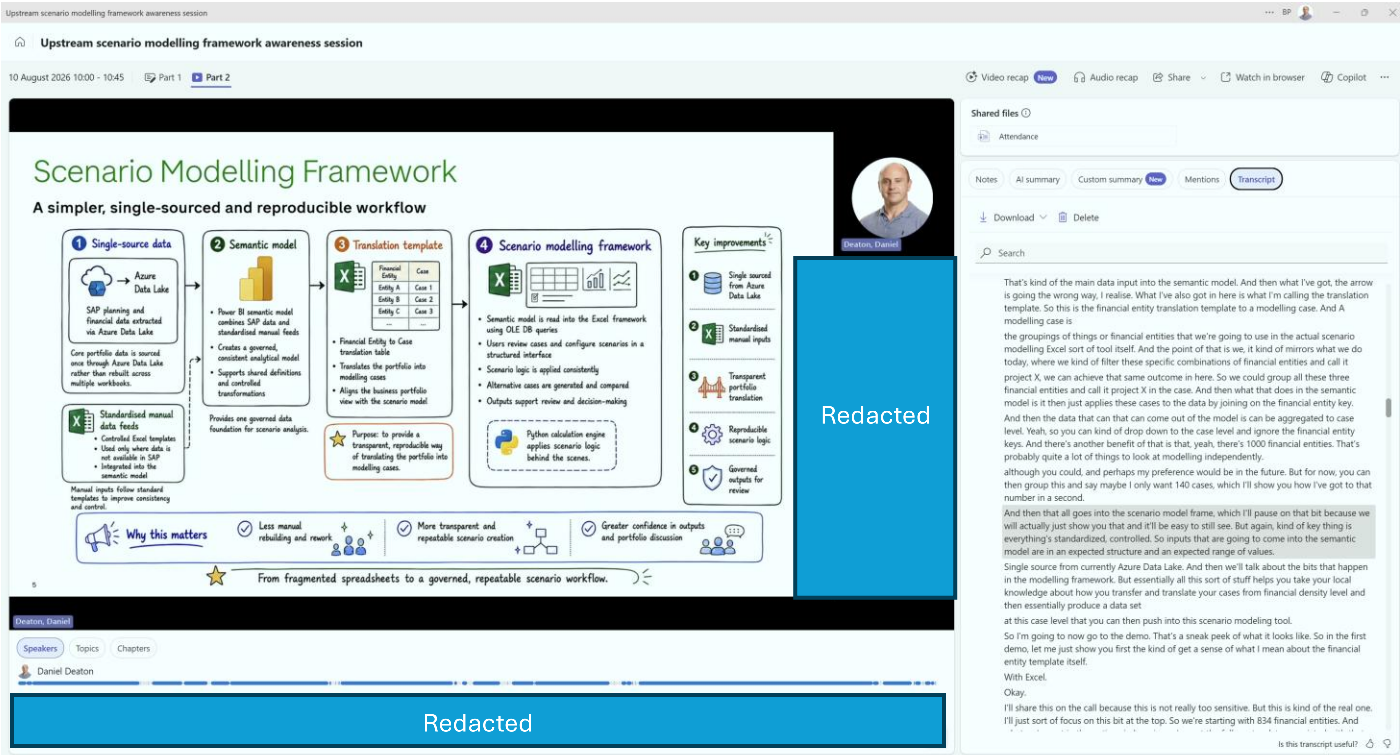
To support the discussion, I am also sharing:

1. A modelling framework design deck explaining the available scenario operations and how they are applied.
2. A short Microsoft Forms survey: [Scenario Modelling Framework Evaluation – Fill in form]

Following the session, and once you have had some hands-on time with the framework, I would also appreciate your support in completing the survey. This will provide a consistent record of SME feedback and help me assess the framework's technical capability, usability, governance, and potential business value.

Many thanks,
Dan

Appendix: Teams Meeting Evidence



Appendix: Business SME Engagement Pack

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Upstream Scenario Modelling Framework

Business SME Engagement Session

Aug-26

Finance

Agenda

Context ➔ Design ➔ Demo ➔ Request

Context

- Business need
- Current state dataflow and workflow
- Scenario Modelling Framework

Demo

1. Financial Entity to Case Translation
2. Scenario Modelling Framework
3. Standardised Input Schedules

Request

- Feedback (MS Forms survey)
- Dan degree support

Business need

Why does Upstream need a scenario modelling framework?

OCTOBER 2025 — REQUEST FROM SVP

Develop a flexible Long-Term Planning (LTP) scenario model for the Upstream Portfolio team, enabling planners to build and compare alternative portfolio scenarios using underlying QPF planning data.

Key considerations: granularity of underlying data, delivered at pace so live portfolio iterations can leverage the model.

Scenario operations

- Switching investment options on or off
- Changing project timing
- Modelling A&D activity
- Assessing commodity price sensitivities
- View data with or without A&D embedded, by region

Compare impacts

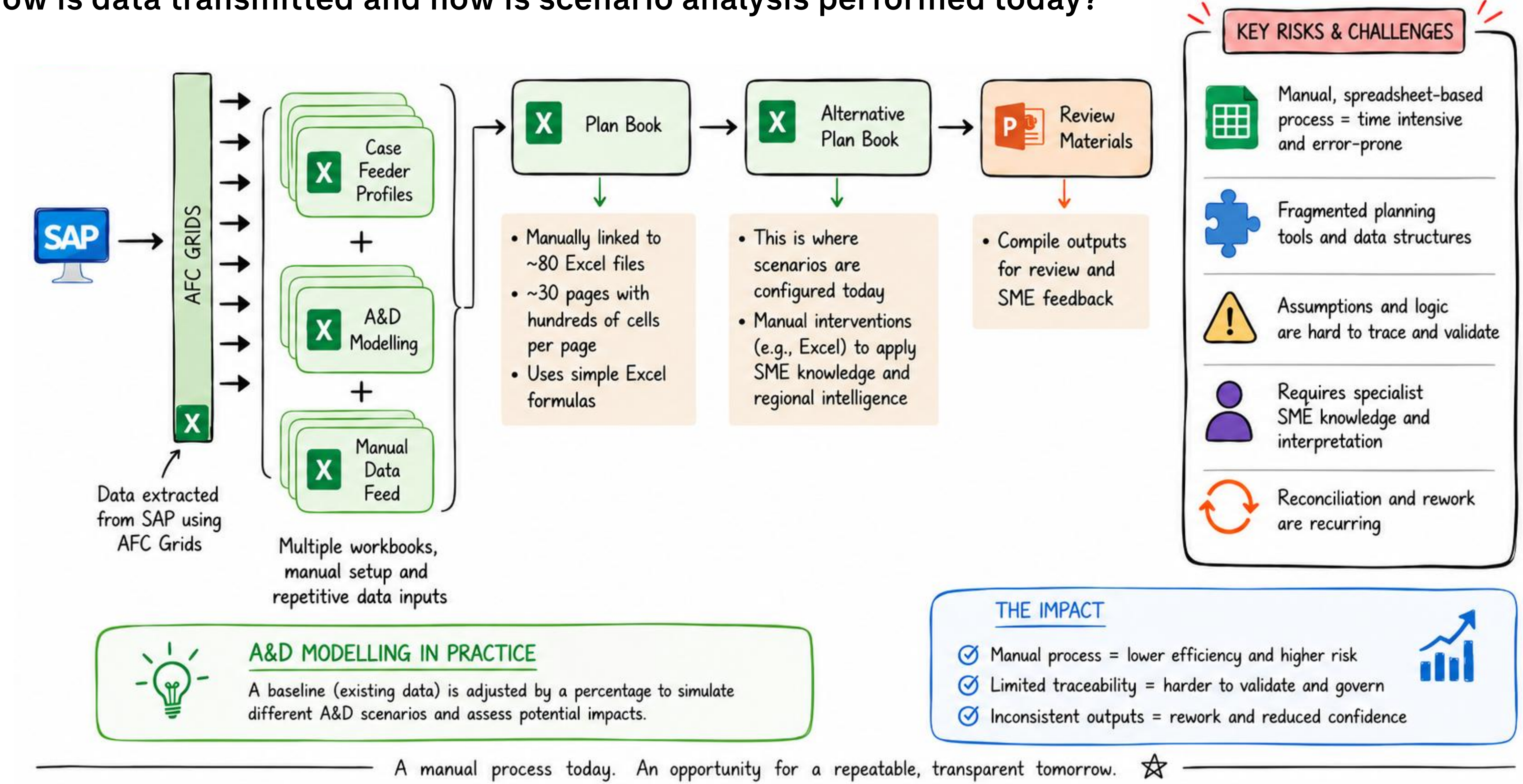
- Production
- Pre- and post-tax earnings and cash flow
- Capital expenditure
- Capital Employed and ROACE
- Leases, DD&A (incl. unit DD&A) and decommissioning

Clear outputs

- Clear, accessible outputs
- Support for portfolio discussions
- Confident decision making
- Output that feeds the group template

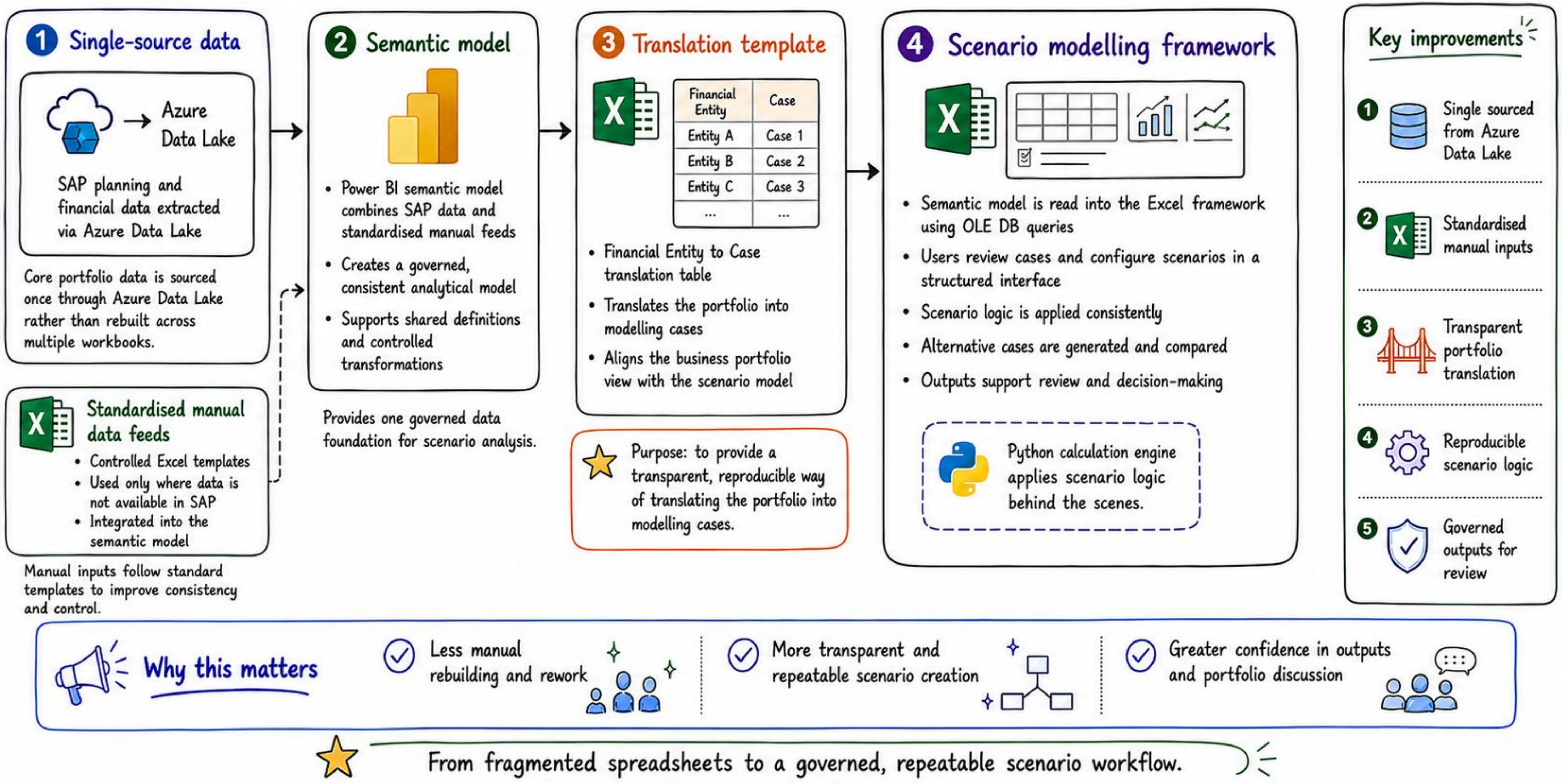
Current state

How is data transmitted and how is scenario analysis performed today?



Scenario Modelling Framework

A simpler, single-sourced and reproducible workflow



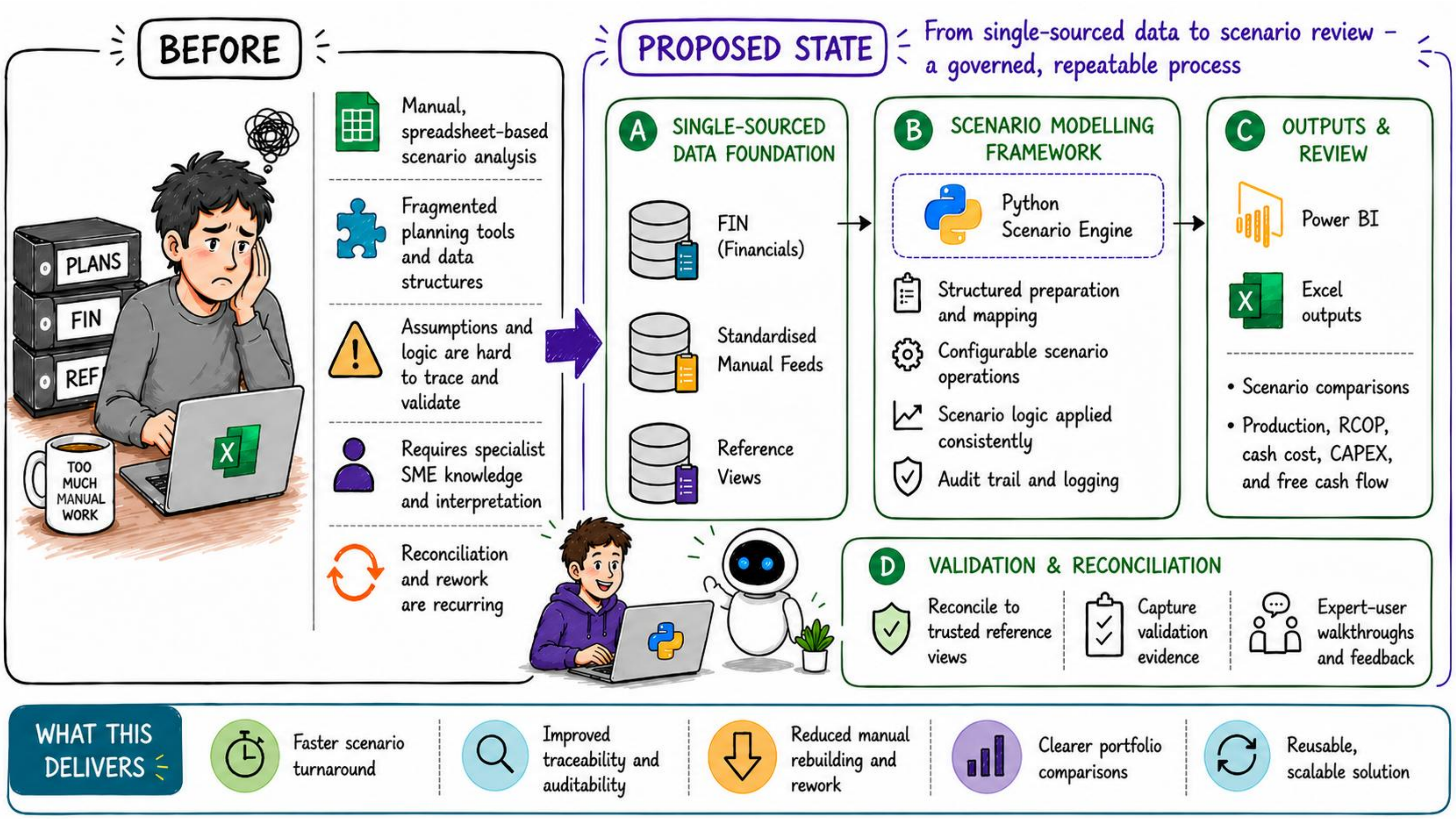
Request

Business impact evidence: quantifiable proof that your solution creates organisational value.

- Improved efficiency and cost savings
- Revenue generated or protected
- Better, faster decision-making
- Stakeholder testimonials and usage metrics
- Integrated into business-as-usual operations

Scenario Modelling Framework Evaluation – Fill in form

What changes?



Thank you